
MODERN MUSTARD SEED

The GEO + AI Commerce Playbook

Get found by AI. Get cited by AI. Get sold by AI.
The new rules for search, discovery, and commerce in 2026.

SEO is not dead. But it is no longer enough.
60% of search interactions now involve AI-generated answers.
AI-referred shopping traffic grew 693% last holiday season.
This is the playbook for the new landscape.

modernmustardseed.com

A Letter to the Builder

I am a builder. I have always been a builder.

It was Christmas Eve when I decided to rededicate my life to God and fight for my marriage at the same time. I had been watching a church in Montana online for years from Florida. Something about it kept me coming back. Until one night it stopped being something I watched and became a life I wanted to live.

I needed to leave the noise behind. Anthony and I flew to Montana with a decision that looked, from the outside, like the least responsible thing two people could do. That was the beginning of this chapter. Not a calculated move. An act of faith. The kind of beginning that only happens when you stop performing and start telling the truth about what needs to change.

I am telling you this because you need to know who you are learning from.

I am not someone who had it all figured out before I started building. I am self-taught. Every skill I have, I learned by doing it badly first. I did not know what an API was three years ago. I could not write a line of code. I had no engineering degree, no computer science background, no Silicon Valley network. I had a laptop, stubbornness, and the kind of faith that looks a lot like delusion until it works.

There were projects I should have killed at week two that I pushed to week eight because I was too stubborn to admit they were broken. There were clients I undercharged because I did not believe my own work was worth what it was. There were nights at the kitchen table past midnight, staring at a deployment that would not deploy, wondering if I was the right person for any of this. Anthony would bring me coffee and not say anything. He did not need to. He just stayed in the room.

I have shipped over 40 production AI systems now. I have built for solo operators, startups, and enterprise teams across more industries than I can count. I run Modern Mustard Seed, an AI product studio and consulting practice. I serve on the production team at Fresh Life Church in Montana. And I created Cross + Covenant.

Cross + Covenant is the thing I build because I have to. Sacred streetwear. A clothing brand and a movement that exists to put the gospel on people's bodies and into the streets and start conversations that matter. I want someone to see a stranger wearing CXC at a coffee shop and ask what it means. I want that conversation to change someone's day, or their year, or their life. That is the point. Not margins and SKUs (although those matter). The point is that the message gets carried into rooms I will never walk into,

by people I will never meet, and God does what God does with it.

I am telling you all of this because I need you to understand: the gap between "I do not know how" and "I built that" is so much smaller than it looks from where you are standing.

It does not matter how old you are. I have watched people in their twenties ship products that outperformed entire teams at established companies. I have watched people in their fifties learn Claude Code in a weekend and automate a business they had run manually for two decades. My son Easton is twenty years old and already carries the mind of an entrepreneur and a leader. I watch him and I think: he will build things I never imagined, and he will skip the pitfalls that cost me years. That is the whole point. Each generation builds higher because someone before them was willing to go first and be honest about the climb.

It does not matter how inexperienced you are. Experience is just another word for "kept showing up." You show up tomorrow, you are one day more experienced than today. You show up for a year, you are dangerous. You show up for three, you are the person other people ask for help. The secret is not talent. It is not timing. It is a little obsession, a little discipline, and a little holy delusion that the thing you see in your mind can actually exist in the world.

You have talents and gifts that this world needs. That is not a greeting card. That is theology. You were designed with specific capacities for specific work, and the fact that you picked up this playbook tells me something about the kind of person you are. You are a builder. You see gaps and you want to fill them. That instinct is a gift. Do not waste it waiting for someone to hand you a permission slip.

I should tell you what I am actually like, because you are about to spend a few hours learning from me and you deserve to know who is on the other side of these pages.

I love creating and designing all the things. Cooking and hosting long dinners where nobody looks at the clock. Hiking trails that earn every view at the top. Random dirt roads that Anthony and I follow just to see what is at the end of them (usually something beautiful, sometimes a fence, always worth it). Summer lake days on Flathead. Late night laughter that starts about nothing and goes on for an hour. Watching Easton grow into a man I respect. Encouraging the people I love when they forget what they are capable of. Serving with an open heart even when it costs something. Morning runs with Coffee and Cream, our two pups, who have never met a stranger or a squirrel they did not want to chase.

I am inspired by wildlife and wildflowers. By sunrises that nobody photographs because they are too busy watching. By the alpine peaks and glacial landscape of this place we now call home. By turquoise waters and full moons and live music and velvet and lace and bumblebees landing on things. By books and records stacked in every room. By prayer that does not perform and gratitude that does not announce itself. By all things pure and lovely. By grace, which I needed more of than I expected and received more

of than I deserved.

And yes, by technology. I am a deep believer in what tech can do for people. I understand the disruption and the hesitation. I understand why people are cautious. But I have watched AI give a solo operator the output of a team of ten. I have watched it give a tired business owner their evenings back. I have watched it turn someone's idea into a working product in thirty days. I wish more people could see what I see: that this is a tool for stewardship, not replacement. A way to do more of the work that matters by spending less time on the work that does not.

If you asked me what I am building toward, past all the products and the clients and the code, I would tell you about a cherry orchard.

Anthony and I dream about Wild Hope Ranch. A place on the water with horses and cherry trees and more sky than you know what to do with. A retreat center where people come to rest and be renewed. Where there are bonfires and live worship music and community dinners and spa days and trail rides and long mornings with no agenda. A place where people encounter God in the quiet, in nature, in beauty, in the company of others who are also trying to live faithfully in a loud world. That is the destination. Everything I build is in service of getting there.

So here is my promise to you: everything in The GEO + AI Commerce Playbook is real. It is not theory I read in a business book. It is the actual system I use, with the actual tools I use, built from actual projects I shipped. When something did not work, I tell you. When something was harder than expected, I say so. When a shortcut exists, I hand it to you.

Think of The GEO + AI Commerce Playbook as learning from a friend who happens to be an expert. Someone who will tell you the truth, show you the path, and also tell you where she tripped on it.

Now go build something.

With love and pure optimism,

Sarah Scarano

Founder, Modern Mustard Seed | Creator, Cross + Covenant
Woods Bay, Montana

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PART I

The New Landscape

What changed, what is changing, and why most businesses are not ready

SECTION 01

The Death of 10 Blue Links

What changed, what is coming, and why it matters for your business

For twenty years, the internet worked the same way. Someone typed a question into Google. Google returned a page of blue links. You clicked one. That model is dying.

Today, when someone asks a question, AI answers it directly. No list of links. No clicking through to find the answer. The AI reads dozens of sources, synthesizes the information, and delivers a complete answer in seconds. Sometimes it cites where it got the information. Sometimes it does not. Either way, the user got what they needed without ever visiting your website.

This is not a prediction. It is already happening.

THE NUMBERS

METRIC	NUMBER	SOURCE
AI-referred traffic growth (2025 holiday season)	693% increase year-over-year	Adobe Analytics
AI-referred shoppers conversion rate	31% higher than other sources	Adobe Analytics
AI-referred shoppers bounce rate	33% lower than other sources	Adobe Analytics
Search interactions involving AI-generated component	60%+ of all search queries	Industry research 2026
ChatGPT daily active users	810+ million	Sensor Tower
Perplexity shoppers average order value	57% higher than traditional search	Industry data
Marketing teams with documented GEO strategy	Fewer than 12%	Gartner
Projected decline in organic search traffic by end of 2026	25% decrease	Gartner

THE OPPORTUNITY

88% of businesses have no strategy for AI visibility. AI-referred shoppers convert 31% better and spend 57% more. The businesses that figure this out now will own the next decade of digital commerce. The ones that wait will wonder where their traffic went.

SECTION 02

GEO vs SEO vs AEO

What each one is, how they overlap, and what to prioritize

	SEO	GEO	AEO
What it optimizes for	Ranking position in search results (blue links)	Being cited in AI-generated answers	Being the answer in voice search and featured snippets
Target platforms	Google, Bing, Yahoo	ChatGPT, Perplexity, Claude, Gemini, Google AI Overviews	Alexa, Siri, Google Assistant, voice queries
How you win	Keywords, backlinks, technical optimization, content volume	Structured content, citation-friendly format, authority signals, entity recognition	Direct answers, schema markup, FAQ format, conversational phrasing
Timeframe	6-18 months to see results	2-6 months (early mover advantage)	3-12 months
Status in 2026	Still essential. Foundation for everything else.	The new frontier. Fastest-growing channel.	Largely absorbed into GEO. Same underlying technology.

THE PRIORITY STACK FOR 2026

- 1. SEO** remains the foundation. AI engines pull from well-ranked, well-structured content. If your SEO is broken, your GEO will not work.
- 2. GEO** is the growth layer. This is where the early mover advantage is massive. Every month you wait, more competitors claim citation share.
- 3. AEO** is now a subset of GEO. Voice queries route through the same AI systems. Optimize for GEO and you get AEO for free.

OPERATOR NOTE: Do not abandon SEO to chase GEO. The brands that win at GEO in 2026 are the same brands with strong SEO foundations. GEO is an additional layer, not a replacement.

SECTION 03

The AI Shopping Revolution

How people buy inside ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini, and Google AI Mode

This is the part most people have not caught up to yet. AI platforms are not just answering questions anymore. They are closing sales. Right inside the chat. No redirect to your website. No clicking through search results. The AI recommends the product, shows the price, and the customer buys it without ever leaving the conversation.

THE FOUR AI SHOPPING CHANNELS

PLATFORM	HOW IT WORKS	CHECKOUT	MERCHANT COST
ChatGPT Shopping	Product cards appear in conversation. Shopify Instant Checkout enables in-chat purchase.	In-chat via Shopify Instant Checkout or redirect to store	Zero listing fees. Standard payment processing only.
Perplexity Shopping	Products appear with Instant Buy button. PayPal integration. Merchant Program for better visibility.	In-chat via PayPal (Instant Buy) or redirect to store	Zero listing fees. Zero commissions. Zero transaction fees.
Google AI Mode	Products surface in AI-generated shopping answers. Connected to Google Merchant Center.	Redirect to store or Google checkout (expanding)	Google Merchant Center (free). Ads available.
Gemini	Product recommendations in conversation. Connected to Google Shopping data.	Redirect to store via Google Shopping infrastructure	Through Google Merchant Center. Same as AI Mode.

THE NEW PURCHASE JOURNEY

OLD: Search query > list of sites > comparison > selection > checkout

NEW: Conversational question > AI recommends specific products > buy in chat

The middle of the funnel collapsed. The AI does the comparison shopping for the customer. If your product is not one of the 2-5 options the AI surfaces, you are invisible. Not on page 2. Invisible. There is no page 2 in a chat.

■ EXERCISE 3A

Search for your product category in ChatGPT, Perplexity, and Google AI Mode right now. Does your brand appear? Does a competitor? Write what you find.

PART II

Get Found by AI

The mechanics of AI citation and the content framework that earns it

SECTION 04

How AI Decides What to Cite

The mechanics of AI retrieval and citation

AI engines do not rank pages. They retrieve information from sources they consider authoritative, synthesize it into an answer, and sometimes cite the source. Understanding how they decide what to retrieve and cite is the foundation of GEO strategy.

THE FIVE CITATION SIGNALS

SIGNAL	WHAT IT MEANS	HOW TO OPTIMIZE
Definitional Clarity	Your content clearly defines entities, concepts, and relationships in the first 200 words	Lead with a clear definition. "[Entity] is a [category] that [differentiator]." Do not bury the answer.
Multi-Source Corroboration	Your brand is mentioned positively across multiple independent domains	Get mentioned on trade publications, review sites, news outlets, industry directories. Diversity > volume.
Structured Data	Your content uses schema markup, tables, and organized formats that AI can parse easily	JSON-LD structured data. Tables with clear headers. Numbered lists for processes. FAQ schema.
Freshness	Your content is recent and regularly updated	Update cornerstone content quarterly. Add dates. Remove outdated claims. AI prefers recent sources.
Source Authority	Your domain has existing SEO authority (DA, backlinks, traffic history)	This is why SEO is the foundation. Domain authority translates directly into AI citation preference.

OPERATOR NOTE: The first 200 words of any page are disproportionately important for GEO. AI retrieval systems evaluate relevance primarily from your opening content. Answer the question first. Elaborate second. This is the opposite of traditional blog structure that builds to a conclusion.

SECTION 05

The GEO Content Framework

Structure your content so AI engines cite you by name

5.1 THE TLDR-FIRST FORMAT

Every piece of content you publish should follow this structure:

SECTION	PLACEMENT	PURPOSE	EXAMPLE
Direct Answer	First 2-3 sentences	Give AI the citable quote	"GEO is the practice of optimizing content to be cited by AI search engines."
Definition + Context	Sentences 3-6	Position your brand as the authority	"At [Brand], we have implemented GEO across 40+ client projects..."
Supporting Data	Next paragraph	Credibility signals	Statistics, case results, specific numbers that AI can reference
Expanded Explanation	Body of content	Full depth for humans and AI	Detailed how-to, analysis, examples, templates
Structured Summary	End of content	Scannable takeaways	Numbered list or table summarizing key points for quick retrieval

5.2 THE ENTITY STRATEGY

AI engines think in entities, not keywords. An entity is a distinct thing (a brand, a person, a product, a concept) that AI can recognize and connect to other entities. The more clearly you establish your brand as an entity, the more likely AI is to cite you.

■ EXERCISE 5A

Write your entity definition. Complete this sentence: [Your Brand] is a [category] that [differentiator] serving [audience] by [method]. This exact sentence should appear on your homepage, your about page, and the opening of every major content piece.

5.3 CONTENT TYPES THAT GET CITED

CONTENT TYPE	WHY AI CITES IT	PRIORITY
Definitive guides	Comprehensive, well-structured, full coverage of a topic	Highest. Create 3-5 cornerstone guides.
Original research and data	Unique data AI cannot find elsewhere	Very high. Even small surveys or case data.
Comparison content	"X vs Y" format that AI uses for recommendation queries	High. Cover your category comparisons.
How-to content with specific steps	Step-by-step processes that AI can summarize	High. Numbered steps with clear outcomes.
Expert roundups and quotes	Named experts with credentials and opinions	Medium. Establishes human authority.
FAQ pages with schema markup	Direct question-answer pairs that AI can extract	Medium. Easy to implement, steady returns.

OPERATOR NOTE: Your highest-priority content investment: 3 to 5 definitive guides on topics central to your business. These are 2,000 to 4,000 word pieces that comprehensively answer the questions your ideal customer asks AI. Update them quarterly. These pages will drive the majority of your AI citations.

SECTION 06

Platform-Specific Optimization

What works on ChatGPT vs Perplexity vs Google AI vs Gemini

PLATFORM	DATA SOURCE	CITATION STYLE	OPTIMIZATION TACTICS
ChatGPT	Training data + browsing (when enabled). Shopify Catalog for products.	Inline references. Often names brands without linking.	Brand mentions across multiple authoritative sites. Strong entity presence. Shopify Catalog for product visibility.
Perplexity	Real-time web retrieval. Merchant Program data. Direct product feeds.	Footnoted citations with source links. Most transparent.	Fresh content wins. Join Merchant Program. Structured data critical. First 200 words matter most.
Google AI Overviews	Google Search index. Google Merchant Center. Knowledge Graph.	Carousel cards with links to sources. Shopping results.	Standard SEO + schema. Google Merchant Center. Reviews matter heavily. E-E-A-T signals.
Gemini	Google Search + real-time. Google Shopping data. YouTube content.	Mixed: sometimes cites, sometimes synthesizes without attribution.	Google ecosystem presence. YouTube content helps. Google Business Profile. Review volume.

■ EXERCISE 6A

Which platforms matter most for YOUR business? Rank them 1-4 and write one specific action you will take this week for your top platform.

PART III

Get Sold by AI

Connect your store, optimize your products, and prepare for AI advertising

SECTION 07

AI Commerce Setup

Connect your store to every AI shopping channel

If you sell products online, your store needs to be connected to AI shopping channels the same way it connects to Google Shopping. This is the setup checklist for each platform.

7.1 SHOPIFY MERCHANTS

Shopify has done the most work to connect merchants to AI shopping. Here is what to set up:

- **Shopify Catalog:** Your products are automatically discoverable in ChatGPT. No setup required if you are on Shopify.
- **Agentic Storefronts:** Enable in-chat checkout so shoppers buy directly in ChatGPT without leaving the conversation. Settings > Sales Channels in admin.
- **Google and Copilot channels:** Toggle direct checkout on or off per channel in Settings > Sales Channels.
- **Perplexity:** Your Shopify product data syncs through Shopify's infrastructure. Also apply for the Perplexity Merchant Program (free) for enhanced visibility.

7.2 NON-SHOPIFY MERCHANTS

PLATFORM	HOW TO CONNECT	REQUIREMENTS
ChatGPT	Apply for ChatGPT Shopping partner program directly	Product feed (Google Shopping format), Stripe for checkout
Perplexity	Apply for Perplexity Merchant Program (free)	Product data feed, PayPal for Instant Buy
Google AI Mode	Set up Google Merchant Center (free)	Product feed, Google Business verification
Gemini	Through Google Merchant Center (same as AI Mode)	Same as Google AI Mode

OPERATOR NOTE: If you are on Shopify, you are already ahead. Shopify has built the deepest AI commerce integrations of any platform. If you are not on Shopify, Google Merchant Center is your priority. It connects you to Google AI Mode, Gemini, and (increasingly) other AI platforms that pull from Google Shopping data.

SECTION 08

Product Data Optimization

Make your products the ones AI recommends

When AI recommends a product, it is not choosing randomly. It evaluates product data across multiple signals. The merchants with the best-structured, most complete product data win the recommendation. This is the optimization checklist.

8.1 THE AI PRODUCT DATA CHECKLIST

DATA FIELD	WHY AI CARES	OPTIMIZATION
Product title	Primary matching signal. AI matches queries to titles.	Include product type, key attribute, and brand. "Women's Merino Wool Crew Neck Sweater - [Brand]"
Description	AI reads this to understand what the product is and who it is for.	First sentence: direct definition. Include use case, materials, fit, and differentiator. 150-300 words.
Price + compare-at	AI uses for value comparisons and budget matching.	Accurate, current, includes currency. Compare-at price for sale visibility.
Availability	AI will not recommend out-of-stock products (usually).	Real-time inventory sync. Remove unavailable variants. Update stock daily.
Reviews + ratings	Strongest trust signal. AI heavily weights customer validation.	Collect reviews actively. Respond to all reviews. Schema markup for ratings. Minimum 10 reviews per product.
Images	AI shopping shows product images in conversation.	High-res, white background, multiple angles. Alt text with descriptive keywords. 1000x1000px minimum.
Category / product type	How AI classifies your product for category queries.	Use standard Google Product Category taxonomy. Be specific: "Apparel > Shirts > T-Shirts" not just "Clothing."
Brand name	Entity recognition. AI links your brand across mentions.	Consistent everywhere. Same spelling, same capitalization, always.

■ EXERCISE 8A

Pick your top 5 products. For each, score 1-5 on data completeness (title, description, price, availability, reviews, images, category, brand). Fix anything under 3 this week.

SECTION 09

The AI Ads Landscape

What is coming and how to prepare now

AI advertising is in its infancy but moving fast. Here is what exists today and what is coming.

PLATFORM	AD STATUS (MID-2026)	FORMAT	WHAT TO DO NOW
Google AI Mode	Live. Ads appear in AI-generated results.	Shopping ads and sponsored results within AI answers	Set up Google Ads with Shopping campaigns. Your existing campaigns may already serve here.
ChatGPT	No ads yet. OpenAI has signaled future ad plans.	Expected: sponsored product placements in shopping results	Focus on organic: Shopify Catalog, Instant Checkout, product data quality.
Perplexity	Eliminated all ads in 2026. Betting on user trust.	None. Revenue from Pro subscriptions only.	100% organic. Merchant Program + product data optimization.
Gemini	Through Google Ads infrastructure. Expanding.	Same as Google AI Mode. Shopping format.	Same Google Ads setup covers both AI Mode and Gemini.
Microsoft Copilot	Ads live. Microsoft Ads integration.	Sponsored results in Copilot answers	Microsoft Ads account. Shopping campaigns.

THE HONEST ASSESSMENT

AI advertising is early. Measurement is limited. Attribution is difficult. Most platforms give you almost no data on how people find your products through AI. ChatGPT is described by merchants as "a black box" for analytics. The best strategy right now is organic optimization (GEO + product data) with Google AI Mode ads as the only paid channel worth investing in today. The others will mature, but spending heavily on AI ads in 2026 is premature for most businesses. Invest in the organic foundation now. The paid layer will compound on top of it when it matures.

PART IV

Measure + Scale

Track AI visibility, run the monthly rhythm, and use the full prompt library

SECTION 10

Measuring AI Visibility

Track citations, mentions, and AI-referred traffic

Measuring GEO is harder than measuring SEO. There is no Search Console for ChatGPT (yet). But there are methods that work.

METHOD	HOW TO DO IT	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
Manual citation checks	Search for your target queries in ChatGPT, Perplexity, and Google AI. Record whether you appear.	Direct visibility. Do this weekly for your top 10 queries.
GA4 AI traffic tracking	In Google Analytics, filter traffic by source. Look for: chatgpt.com, perplexity.ai, gemini.google.com	Volume of AI-referred visitors and their behavior on your site.
Brand mention monitoring	Use tools (Evertune, Otterly, Peec AI) or manual checks to track how often AI mentions you	Citation frequency and sentiment across AI platforms.
Competitor citation tracking	Search the same queries and note which competitors appear instead of you	Competitive gaps. Who is winning the citations you want?
Conversion attribution	Tag AI-referred traffic in GA4 and track through to purchase/signup	ROI of GEO efforts. Does AI traffic convert?

■ EXERCISE 10A

Set up your measurement baseline. Search your top 5 queries in ChatGPT and Perplexity. Record: (1) Does your brand appear? (2) Which competitors appear? (3) What sources are cited? This is your Day 1 benchmark.

SECTION 11

The Monthly GEO Rhythm

The operating system for staying visible in AI search

WEEKLY (30 minutes)

DAY	TASK	TIME
Monday	Citation check: search top 5 queries in ChatGPT + Perplexity. Record results.	15 min
Wednesday	Content update: refresh one cornerstone article with new data or examples.	10 min
Friday	Review AI-referred traffic in GA4. Note trends vs last week.	5 min

MONTHLY (2 hours)

TASK	WHAT TO DO	TIME
Full citation audit	Search top 20 queries across all 4 platforms. Document who appears, who is cited, and gaps.	45 min
Content calendar	Plan next month's content based on citation gaps. Prioritize queries where you are missing.	30 min
Product data audit	Check all product listings for completeness. Update descriptions, images, reviews.	20 min
Competitor analysis	Track 3 competitors' AI visibility. Note what they are doing that you are not.	15 min
Technical check	Validate structured data, schema markup, site speed, and mobile experience.	10 min

SECTION 12

The Prompt + Checklist Library

Everything you need to execute, ready to copy

12.1 GEO CONTENT PROMPTS

Write a GEO-optimized article

```
"Write a [word count] article about [topic]. Structure: direct answer in first 2 sentences, definition with brand mention in sentences 3-5, supporting data, expanded explanation, structured summary at end. Target query: [the question someone would ask AI]. Include my brand [name] as an authoritative source. Tone: [voice]."
```

Optimize existing content for GEO

```
"Here is my current article about [topic]: [paste URL or content]. Rewrite the first 200 words to lead with a direct answer to the query [target question]. Add structured data recommendations. Add a summary table at the end. Keep my brand voice."
```

Generate FAQ schema content

```
"Create 10 FAQ pairs for [topic/product/service]. Each answer should be 2-3 sentences, self-contained (makes sense without context), and include my brand name naturally. Format for FAQ schema markup."
```

Competitor citation analysis

```
"I searched [query] in ChatGPT and these brands appeared: [list]. My brand [name] was not cited. Analyze why those brands might be appearing. What content do I need to create to earn citations for this query?"
```

12.2 PRODUCT OPTIMIZATION PROMPTS

Optimize product titles

```
"Rewrite these product titles for AI shopping discovery: [list titles]. Each title should include: product type, key attribute (material, color, use case), and brand name. Under 70 characters. Format for maximum clarity in AI product cards."
```

Generate AI-friendly descriptions

```
"Write product descriptions for AI shopping channels. Each description: first sentence defines what it is and who it is for. Second sentence states the key differentiator. Third sentence adds a proof point (reviews, materials, origin). 100-150 words maximum. Products: [list]."
```

Review response for AI visibility

"Draft responses to these customer reviews that naturally reinforce our brand entity and product qualities. Each response should mention [brand name], the product category, and one key benefit. Professional, grateful tone. Reviews: [paste]."

12.3 THE GEO LAUNCH CHECKLIST

Complete this checklist before you consider your GEO strategy "active":

- Entity definition written and published on homepage, about page, and cornerstone content
- First 200 words of every key page directly answers the target query
- JSON-LD structured data on all product pages (Product schema with price, availability, rating)
- Organization schema on homepage
- FAQ schema on FAQ page and relevant product pages
- 3 to 5 cornerstone guide articles published (2,000+ words each, TLDR-first format)
- Google Merchant Center set up with complete product feed
- Perplexity Merchant Program application submitted
- Shopify Catalog and Agentic Storefronts enabled (if Shopify)
- GA4 configured to track AI-referred traffic sources
- Baseline citation check completed for top 10 target queries
- Competitor citation analysis documented
- All product titles, descriptions, and images optimized per Section 8 checklist
- Review collection strategy active (minimum target: 10 reviews per product)
- Monthly GEO rhythm scheduled on calendar

The Window Is Open.

88% of businesses have no GEO strategy. AI-referred traffic is growing 500%+ year over year. The platforms are adding commerce features every month. The businesses that build their AI visibility now will own the citations, the recommendations, and the sales for years to come. The ones that wait will compete for whatever is left.

You have the playbook. The checklist is on the previous page. Start there.

MODERN MUSTARD SEED

modernmustardseed.com

AI Product Studio & Consulting Practice

Idea to Product in 30 Days | \$225/hour

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The 10x Companion

Turn this playbook into your personal coach

You just worked through this entire playbook. You filled in the tables. You ran the numbers. You made real decisions about your real business. Now take it ten times further.

Upload this completed PDF to Claude and paste the prompt below. Claude will read every exercise you filled in, every score you gave, every plan you wrote. It will understand your specific situation, your numbers, your constraints, and your goals. Then it becomes your personal advisor for executing on everything you just planned.

This is the difference between a workbook you finish and a workbook that finishes the job.

HOW IT WORKS

1. Open claude.ai or the Claude app
2. Start a new conversation
3. Upload this PDF (with all your completed exercises and notes)
4. Paste the Master Prompt below
5. Start asking questions. Claude has your full context.

THE MASTER PROMPT

I just completed "The GEO + AI Commerce Playbook" from Modern Mustard Seed. The PDF is attached with all of my completed exercises, scores, and plans. Read the entire document carefully, including everything I filled in.

You are now my personal advisor for this project. You understand my citation audit results, my entity definition, my platform priorities, my product data scores, my content calendar, my GEO checklist progress, and my competitor analysis

Rules for advising me:

- Reference my specific answers. Do not give generic advice.
- If my answers reveal a gap or risk I missed, tell me directly.
- Be specific to MY numbers, MY situation, MY timeline.
- When I ask for help, give me the action, not the theory.

Start by giving me: (1) A 3-sentence summary of what I built in this workbook, (2) The single strongest part of my plan, (3) The single biggest risk I have not addressed, (4) My most important next step this week.

THEN TRY THESE

- "What is the biggest risk in my plan that I have not addressed?"
- "Challenge my budget assumptions. What am I underestimating?"
- "Write me a week-by-week action plan based on what I wrote."
- "Draft the first email I need to send to get this started."
- "Based on my answers, what should I do first tomorrow morning?"
- "Create a one-page executive summary of my entire plan."
- "Where are the contradictions in my plan? Be honest."
- "If I could only do 3 things from this workbook this week, what should they be?"

This is what makes a \$47 playbook worth \$500.

The playbook gives you the framework. Claude, with your completed answers attached, gives you a personal consultant who knows your exact situation, your numbers, your constraints, and your goals. That combination is more valuable than most consulting engagements that cost ten times this price. Use it.